

Hey Rohan, good speaking with you today. You asked three sharp questions that deserved sharper answers than you got on the call -- so here they are.

Your questions answered

1 Coursera is free. What does Rs. 3.5L actually buy you?

Andrew Ng is genuinely good for concepts -- no argument there. The gap is not content, it is **execution infrastructure**. Scaler gives you live classes 3x a week with industry instructors, 1:1 mentorship with active professionals, and 50+ hands-on projects -- none of which Coursera provides. More importantly for your situation: 900+ hiring partners and a 100,000+ alumni network are actively used for placement, which means your resume lands differently than it would after a self-paced certificate. Free content teaches you; this is built to get you hired at a specific type of company.

2 Will this actually move you out of service-company territory?

You were direct about this: 14 LPA to 16 LPA at another TCS-equivalent is not the point. I respect that framing and I will not throw a number at you that I cannot back up for your specific profile. What I can tell you is that Scaler publishes a median salary hike of **~110% for the DS/ML track** on their website -- that is the only verified figure I have. Whether that maps to a 4-YoE SDE-2 with your AWS cert and banking-domain background moving into AI engineering roles at product companies is a conversation your admissions advisor needs to walk through with actual placement data for comparable profiles. That is the one question worth pushing hard on in your next call -- ask for outcomes for people who came in at your level and track where they landed.

3 RAG, agents, evals -- is it in the curriculum or just on the brochure?

This one I can answer directly: the curriculum explicitly includes **Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration** under the AI and Agents module, plus an Agentic AI elective. That is not theoretical ML -- that is the applied LLM stack you described wanting to build on. How deep the evals component goes and what the project work looks like in practice is worth confirming on your next call, but the topics you named are listed as core curriculum, not add-ons.

4 You said you are worried about being too late to AI engineering

You are not too late -- but the window for entering as a builder rather than a spectator is not infinite either. You already have 4 years of real engineering experience and an AWS cert; that is a stronger foundation than most people starting this transition. The entrance test is the next concrete step: it is what gates you into the second call where you can get the placement specifics and cohort details that actually matter for your decision. Think of it as the fastest way to get from 'maybe' to a real answer.

TODAY

Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.

TARGET PATH

Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.

NOW

Skills audit & entrance clarity

0-4 MO

Core foundations & habits

4-8 MO

Depth projects & design

8-12 MO

Interview readiness

Take the entrance test when you are ready -- it is the one move that gets you from this PDF to actual numbers and a real offer.